Copy
Pr. of Kung
to
Mr Wade
6 Nov: 1874.

Incl: No
In Mr Wade's No 219
of 16 Nov: 1874.

98

Peking
November 16. 1874

No 220

My Lord,

In continuation of the foregoing Despatch I have the Honor to inclose copies of two Despatches I had addreſsed to Sir Charles Shadwell regarding the Agreement signed by the High Commiſsioner of Japan, and the evacuation of Formosa.

2

The first is to claim his influence, which I felt sure would be valuably exerted, towards the prevention of remarks that might be distasteful to the Government either of China or Japan, in respect of the terms of the Agreement.

The,
Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

The second is to request him to take steps for the more than usually watchful care of British interests at Taiwan and Amoy until the evacuation of Formosa should be past all doubt completed.

I have the Honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord
Your Lordship's most obedient,
Humble Servant,
Thomas Francis Wade.

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29

1874.

Peking. Novr 16
Mr Wade
No 220
Recd 4 Jan 2 Incl.
by mail

Formosa

Admiral requested to support agreement and watch coast.

by approve
Feb 4.

6

Peking.
4th November, 1874.

Confidential

Copy.

Sir,

In continuation of the foregoing Despatch of this date I have the honor to state that the High Commissioner Okubo did seem really anxious to withdraw the Japanese troops from Formosa. The Minister Yanagiwara has impressed me as not being equally pacific, and he has called to say that as soon as he can

Sir C. Shadwell K.C.B.
&c. &c. &c.

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can have his Audience he returns, on leave, to Yedo. Your Excellency will like myself have read what has been written regarding the refusal of the Japanese troops or their General to turn back even when a Secretary of State had been sent to Nagasaki to recal them, and having so recently visited Japan, you are better able than myself to judge of the feeling reported to prevail in that country in favor

of

of war. On the other hand, the Chinese troops have shewn themselves as insubordinate as they are unfit otherwise for the field, and nothing is more likely, than when once the Japanese begin to move, the Chinese may exhibit some of that braggart spirit of which, when they believe themselves safe, we have had so large an experience. I should be glad therefore that Your Excellency were enabled to keep a rather larger force than usual in the neighbourhood of Taiwan and Amoy. If the Chinese troops get at all out of hand, the community at the former port, Taiwan, may require additional protection, against the Chinese, while if any action on the part of the Chinese were to provoke the Japanese to hostility, Amoy is the point at which, I presume, a blow would be struck. It would prove, I imagine, both easy and profitable.

I have &c.

(Signed) T. F. Wade

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Copy. Confidential
Mr Wade
to
Sir Ch. Shadwell
China and Japan.
Inclosure No ~~2~~ 1
in Mr Wade's
No 220 of
Nov. 16 1874.

Peking, 4th November 1874.

Confidential

Copy.

Sir,

I had hoped ere this to be able to communicate confidentially to Your Excellency the text of the Agreement signed, as I stated in my Despatch of the 1st instant, by the High Commissioner Okubo on the preceding day. I have not yet officially received it. However, as I think it of some

Sir C. Shadwell K.C.B.
&c. &c. &c.

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some consequence that its provisions should be known to you, I take on me to inform you that the Chinese Government agrees at once to pay the sum of 100,000 taels as compensation to the families of the Japanese subjects whose murder or ill-treatment by the Aborigines of Formosa was the ostensible occasion of the expedition from Japan. It will pay a farther sum of 400,000 taels on the 20th

December,

December, by which date the Japanese Government engages to have all its troops on the island withdrawn, the latter sum to be paid in ~~a~~ indemnification of the expense which the Japanese have been put to in the making of roads, the erection of buildings, &c. The Chinese Government farther agrees to cast no blame on the Government of Japan for having sent this expedition to Formosa. It promises at the same time itself to take steps that will prevent repetition of such outrages on the part of the Aborigines, as have been complained of. It is also agreed that the whole of the Correspondence on both sides shall be regarded as *non-avenue*.

By the suppression of the Correspondence; by the omission of all reference whatever, on the part of China, to the expedition as an act of hostility, or on the part

of

of Japan to the alleged independence of the territory occupied, and by the simple stipulation that the payment on one side and the withdrawal of the troops on the other, shall be effected on the same day, neither act appearing to be the condition of the other, offence has been avoided to those susceptibilities which have been so much in the way of an adjustment.

I consider the attainment of this last point as scarcely second in importance to the actual withdrawal of the Japanese force from a position its retention of which would have secured to both Empires a long enduring struggle, certainly disastrous to themselves, and too possibly injurious to every power interested in their trade.

Although I think that a majority of our local public now appreciates the danger to which their interests would have been

exposed

exposed by such a war, there are still not a few to whom the news of peace will be a disappointment, and by these we may expect that every effort will be made to render such persons of weight in either country as they may have access to, dissatisfied with the form or substance of the arrangement accepted.

Assured as I am that Your Excellency will view the matter as I view it, I shall be greatly obliged if you avail yourself of any opportunity you may have of endorsing the opinion that by the terms agreed to neither party greatly suffers, while in the form of the agreement there is nothing that will enable either to claim preponderant advantage, and that this is the secret guarantee of peace.

I mark the Despatch Confidential for form's sake, because what I write is, I repeat, known to me only officieusement.

I have &c.
(Signed) T. F. Wade.

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I have &c.

(Signed) T. F. Wade.

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Copy. Confidential
Mr. Wade
to
Sir Ch. Shadwell.

China and Japan

Inclosure No 2
in Mr Wade's
No 220 of
Nov. 16 1874

No 221

Peking.
November 16. 1874.

My Lord,

The Ministers Mao, Tung, Shen, Chêng, and Hsia, the first three being those with whom I had had most to confer in the settlement of the Japanese affair, wrote when all was over to say that on the 8th instant they would call to thank me and Mr Mayers for the trouble we had taken.

I thought that I might improve the occasion by the inclosed note, and I followed it up by some remarks

The Right Honble
The Earl of Derby
& & &